Project | CeraVe SEO Research

Brand Overview: As the global brand team behind CeraVe, our mission is to make dermatologist-developed skincare accessible to all. "CeraVe for All" reflects our promise to every skin type, age, and lifestyle. Our formulas are barrier-restoring, clinically backed, and easy to understand—no fluff, just real results.

Campaign Objective: We know that for many men, skincare starts with a Google search. This campaign is about showing up at that exact moment with helpful, search-optimized content. By creating blog posts that match Carlos's questions and concerns, we can build trust, drive discovery, and connect him to CeraVe solutions in a way that feels natural and credible.

Target Audience: We're targeting **Carlos – The Practical Skincare Researcher** (click for persona details), a 36-year-old Latino man who uses Google to solve skincare problems like dryness or product confusion. Carlos represents a high-intent, underserved audience segment that prefers functional, science-backed solutions. He's not active on Instagram or TikTok, so SEO and YouTube are essential to reaching him.

Blog Content Focus: Carlos turns to search engines to educate himself, compare options, and find simple routines. Search-optimized blog content gives us the opportunity to answer his questions, introduce helpful solutions, and earn his trust early in his skincare journey.

Project Tasks

1. Research & Prep

If we're going to meet Carlos where he searches, we need to speak his language—and that starts with the right keywords. Start by getting familiar with CeraVe's brand voice and the *Skin Smarts* blog. Research how CeraVe speaks to men, and get to know Carlos, the target persona (linked here). Analyze his pain points, search habits, and priorities— your keyword strategy and blog content should speak directly to him.

2. Keyword Research

Review the keyword list below and expand it by **adding at least 10 new keywords**. Aim for high-intent keywords Carlos is likely searching. Use tools like Google Trends and Semrush to analyze the best keywords and uncover additional ideas. You may use the methods suggested by Rita in videos, as well as AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Claude).

Try this prompt

*Act as an SEO strategist. I'm writing blog content for CeraVe to help **[INSERT CUSTOMER PERSONA DETAILS]** with dry skin who searches Google for skincare advice. Suggest 10 informational or commercial-intent keywords he might use. Include a mix of problem-solving, comparison-based, and product-related terms with good search potential.*

💡 **Notes:**

- The first 10 keyword ideas are provided. You'll add 10+ more keyword ideas.
- Fill in the table's columns for all 20+ keywords
- TREND should be researched on Google trends
- VOLUME, KD, and INTENT should be researched on Semrush

(Fill out the table and add keywords below 👇)

	KEYWORD BRAINSTORM *(10 provided, you need to add 10+)*	**TREND**	**VOLUME**	**DIFFICULTY (KD)**	**INTENT**
1	how to start a skincare routine for men	No Data			
2	best skincare products for men 2024	Down			
3	is cerave good for men	Down			
4	face wash steps for beginners	No Data			
5	cerave vs cetaphil cleanser	Down			
6	how to treat dry skin without moisturizer	No Data			
7	best drugstore skincare routine for men	No Data			
8	what causes flaky skin on face	Down			
9	fragrance free skincare for sensitive skin	No Data			
10	how to pick the right cleanser	Down			
11	skincare routine for men	Down			
12	**dry skin care routine**	Down			
13	best skincare routine for dry skin men	Down			
14	**simple skincare routine for beginners**	Up			
15	how to repair skin barrier naturally	Up			
16	cerave vs cetaphil for dry skin	Up			
17	best cleanser for dry skin men	Down			
18	**how to fix flaky skin on face**	Up			

	KEYWORD BRAINSTORM *(10 provided, you need to add 10+)*	**TREND**	**VOLUME**	**DIFFICULTY (KD)**	**INTENT**
19	**niacinamide serum for skin**	Down			
20	ceramide moisturizer for dry skin	Down			
		No Data			
		No Data			

3. Create Keyword-Rich Blog Content

Based on your analysis you filled out in the table above, select the most useful keywords and incorporate them into your content as you **create three blog posts** (each 500-700 words) designed to inform, guide, and build trust with Carlos.

Focus on topics Carlos might search (e.g., dry skin, ingredients, choosing the right cleanser, etc.). Include 3–5 keywords from your keyword ideas table in each post (especially informational and commercial keywords).

You are encouraged to use AI tools like ChatGPT or Claude to create high-quality content quickly, but remember, AI is just a starting point, not your final draft. Adjust the suggested prompt below for each blog post you write, and be sure to edit the output!

Try this prompt

*Act as an SEO content writer for CeraVe. I'm writing a blog post (500–700 words) to help **[INSERT CUSTOMER PERSONA DETAILS]**.*

*Use a helpful, no-fluff tone that feels like CeraVe's Skin Smarts blog. Here are the SEO keywords I want you to include: **[INSERT YOUR CHOSEN 3–5 KEYWORDS HERE]**. Use them naturally throughout the post. Suggest a strong, search-optimized blog title that aligns with these keywords and Carlos's concerns.*

(Paste your blog posts content below 👇)

Blog 1: The Best Skincare Routine for Dry Skin in Men: Simple Steps That Actually Work

If you've ever searched Google for **"what causes dry skin on face"** or **"best cleanser for dry skin men,"** you're not alone. Many men start caring about skincare after noticing flaky patches, tightness after washing, or irritation that doesn't seem to go away.

The good news is that improving dry skin usually doesn't require a complicated routine. With the right products and a few simple habits, you can support your skin barrier and keep your skin feeling comfortable and healthy.

This guide breaks down the **best skincare routine for dry skin men** so you can understand what's happening with your skin—and how to fix it.

What Causes Dry Skin on the Face?

Dry facial skin usually happens when the skin barrier becomes weakened and loses moisture faster than it can replace it. Your skin barrier acts as a protective layer that locks hydration in and keeps irritants out.

Common reasons for dry skin include:

- Harsh face cleansers or bar soaps
- Long hot showers
- Cold weather or dry climates
- Skipping moisturizer
- Using products with alcohol or fragrance

When the barrier becomes compromised, you may notice tightness, flakes, redness, or rough patches. Understanding **what causes dry skin on face** is the first step toward fixing it.

Step 1: Use the Best Cleanser for Dry Skin Men

Your cleanser plays a major role in how your skin feels after washing. Many traditional soaps strip away natural oils, which can make dryness worse.

The **best cleanser for dry skin men** should clean your skin without disrupting the protective barrier. Look for formulas that are gentle, fragrance-free, and designed for sensitive or dry skin types.

Ingredients like **ceramides, hyaluronic acid, and glycerin** help support hydration while still removing dirt, sweat, and excess oil.

Washing your face twice a day—morning and evening—is usually enough. Overwashing can actually increase dryness.

Step 2: Moisturize to Strengthen the Skin Barrier

Moisturizing is essential if you want to **repair skin barrier naturally** and keep your skin hydrated throughout the day.

A good moisturizer works by restoring lipids that naturally exist in your skin barrier. These lipids help seal moisture inside your skin.

Look for moisturizers that contain:

- **Ceramides** – help restore and maintain the skin barrier
- **Hyaluronic acid** – attracts hydration to the skin
- **Glycerin** – helps retain moisture

Applying moisturizer right after washing your face helps trap water in the skin and prevents further dryness.

Step 3: Choose Products That Support the Skin Barrier

When trying to improve dry skin, it's helpful to focus on barrier-supporting skincare rather than harsh treatments.

If you're comparing options, you might come across searches like **"CeraVe vs Cetaphil for dry skin."** Both brands are known for gentle formulas designed for sensitive skin. However, products that include multiple ceramides are specifically designed to help restore the skin's natural barrier while providing hydration.

Barrier-supporting products can make a noticeable difference when dryness is caused by irritation or over-cleansing.

Step 4: Keep Your Routine Simple

One of the biggest myths about skincare is that you need a lot of products. In reality, the **best skincare routine for dry skin men** is usually simple and consistent.

A basic routine looks like this:

Morning

1. Gentle cleanser
2. Moisturizer
3. Sunscreen if spending time outdoors

Evening

1. Gentle cleanser
2. Moisturizer

Following this routine daily helps maintain hydration and allows your skin barrier to recover over time.

The Bottom Line

Dry skin can feel frustrating, but it's usually manageable with the right approach. Understanding **what causes dry skin on face**, using the **best cleanser for dry skin men**, and choosing moisturizers that support your skin barrier can make a big difference.

If your goal is to **repair skin barrier naturally**, consistency matters more than complexity. Stick with a simple routine, avoid harsh ingredients, and give your skin time to adjust.

With the right products and habits, healthier, more comfortable skin is achievable—without overthinking your routine.

Blog 2: Simple Skincare Routine for Men With Dry Skin: A Dermatologist-Recommended Guide

Dry, tight, or flaky skin is a common issue for many men—especially after washing your face or spending time in dry environments. The good news is that improving dry skin doesn't require a complicated routine. A simple skincare routine for men with dry skin can help restore hydration, strengthen the skin barrier, and keep your skin looking healthy.

The key is choosing gentle products and sticking to a routine that focuses on cleansing, moisturizing, and protecting your skin barrier.

Why Dry Skin Happens

Dry skin often occurs when the skin barrier loses moisture. Harsh cleansers, hot showers, cold weather, and environmental stressors can strip away natural oils that help protect your skin.

When the skin barrier becomes weakened, moisture escapes more easily. This can lead to flaking, tightness, irritation, and dull-looking skin.

A consistent routine that focuses on hydration and barrier support can help restore balance.

Step 1: Use a Gentle Cleanser

Cleansing removes dirt, sweat, and oil from your skin, but harsh soaps can make dryness worse. Choosing a gentle face wash for dry sensitive skin helps clean your skin without removing the moisture it needs.

Look for a cleanser that is:

- **Fragrance-free**
- **Hydrating rather than foaming**
- **Formulated for sensitive or dry skin**

A gentle hydrating cleanser helps remove impurities while supporting your skin barrier. Wash your face with lukewarm water once in the morning and once at night. Avoid hot water, which can strip natural oils and increase dryness.

Step 2: Moisturize to Support the Skin Barrier

After cleansing, applying a moisturizer is one of the most important steps in a simple skincare routine for men with dry skin. Moisturizers help replenish hydration and protect the skin barrier from moisture loss.

Dermatologists often recommend moisturizers containing ingredients like hyaluronic acid and ceramides. Understanding the ceramides for dry skin benefits helps explain why they are so effective.

Ceramides are naturally occurring lipids that help hold skin cells together and form a protective barrier. When ceramide levels decrease, the skin barrier becomes weaker, which can lead to dryness and irritation.

Using products formulated with ceramides can help:

- **Restore the skin barrier**
- **Improve moisture retention**
- **Reduce dryness and irritation**
- **Support smoother, healthier-looking skin**

For best results, apply moisturizer immediately after washing your face while the skin is slightly damp.

Step 3: Keep Your Routine Consistent

Many people assume skincare has to involve multiple steps or complicated products, but consistency matters more than complexity.

A basic routine like this can make a noticeable difference:

Morning

1. **Cleanse with a gentle face wash for dry sensitive skin**

2. Apply a moisturizer with barrier-supporting ingredients

3. Use sunscreen if you will be outside

Evening

1. Cleanse your face again

2. Apply a hydrating moisturizer

Following this routine daily helps support the skin's natural barrier and maintain hydration.

Extra Tips for Managing Dry Skin

Small habits can also help improve dry skin.

Avoid hot showers. Hot water can strip natural oils from the skin.

Choose fragrance-free products. Fragrance may irritate sensitive skin.

Moisturize after showering. Applying moisturizer to slightly damp skin helps lock in hydration.

Stay consistent. It may take several weeks for your skin barrier to fully recover.

The Bottom Line

Dry skin doesn't require a complicated routine to manage. A simple skincare routine for men with dry skin—built around gentle cleansing and daily hydration—can help restore moisture and improve skin comfort.

Using a gentle face wash for dry sensitive skin and moisturizing with barrier-supporting ingredients like ceramides can help strengthen your skin's natural defenses. Understanding the ceramides for dry skin benefits highlights why dermatologists recommend them for maintaining hydrated, healthy-looking skin.

With the right routine and consistent care, managing dry skin can be simple, effective, and easy to maintain.

Blog 3:How to Choose a Gentle Face Wash for Dry, Sensitive Skin

If your face feels tight, dry, or irritated after washing, your cleanser may be too harsh. Many people assume all face washes work the same way, but the wrong cleanser can strip away the natural oils your skin needs to stay healthy. Choosing a **gentle face wash for dry sensitive skin** can make a major difference in how your skin looks and feels.

For men like Carlos who want effective skincare without complicated steps, the right cleanser is the foundation of a **simple skincare routine for men with dry skin**. A good cleanser removes dirt and sweat while helping maintain the skin's natural moisture barrier.

Why Your Cleanser Matters

Your skin barrier plays an important role in protecting your skin from environmental stressors while keeping moisture inside. When this barrier becomes weakened, your skin may start to feel tight, flaky, or irritated.

Harsh soaps and overly foaming cleansers can remove too much oil from the skin, leaving it dry and uncomfortable. Switching to a **gentle face wash for dry sensitive skin** helps clean the skin without disrupting this protective barrier.

A hydrating cleanser supports your skin by removing impurities while helping maintain its natural balance.

What to Look for in a Gentle Cleanser

Not all cleansers are formulated the same way. If you have dry or sensitive skin, certain ingredients and features can help protect your skin barrier.

When choosing a cleanser, look for products that are:

- **Fragrance-free**, which helps reduce irritation
- **Hydrating**, rather than harshly foaming
- **Formulated for sensitive or dry skin**
- **Made with barrier-supporting ingredients**

These types of cleansers clean the skin without stripping away the moisture your skin needs.

The Importance of Ceramides for Dry Skin

One of the most important ingredients to look for in a cleanser or moisturizer is ceramides. Understanding the **ceramides for dry skin benefits** can help explain why dermatologists often recommend them.

Ceramides are lipids naturally found in the skin barrier. They help hold skin cells together and create a protective layer that prevents moisture from escaping. When ceramide levels are low, the skin barrier becomes weaker, which can lead to dryness, irritation, and flaking.

Using products that contain ceramides can help:

- Restore and strengthen the skin barrier
- Improve moisture retention
- Reduce dryness and irritation
- Support healthier-looking skin

Including ceramides in your routine can help protect your skin while keeping it hydrated throughout the day.

How Cleansing Fits Into a Simple Routine

For many men, skincare works best when it's straightforward and easy to maintain. A **simple skincare routine for men with dry skin** doesn't require many products—just the right ones used consistently.

A basic routine might look like this:

Morning

1. Wash your face with a **gentle face wash for dry sensitive skin**
2. Apply a moisturizer with hydrating ingredients
3. Use sunscreen if you will be outdoors

Evening

1. Cleanse your face again to remove sweat, oil, and dirt
2. Apply a moisturizer to help restore hydration overnight

Following this routine helps support your skin barrier and maintain healthy hydration.

Tips for Washing Dry or Sensitive Skin

Small changes to your daily habits can also help improve dry skin.

Use lukewarm water instead of hot water. Hot water can remove natural oils from the skin.

Avoid over-washing your face. Washing twice a day is usually enough.

Pat your skin dry. Rubbing your skin with a towel may cause irritation.

Moisturize after cleansing. Applying moisturizer while the skin is slightly damp helps lock in hydration.

The Bottom Line

If your skin feels dry or irritated after washing, your cleanser may be the problem. Choosing a **gentle face wash for dry sensitive skin** helps clean your skin without removing the moisture it needs.

Understanding the **ceramides for dry skin benefits** also highlights why dermatologists often recommend products that help strengthen the skin barrier. When paired with a moisturizer, the right cleanser becomes the foundation of a **simple skincare routine for men with dry skin**.

With the right products and a consistent routine, maintaining comfortable, healthy-looking skin can be easier than you think.

4. Reflect and Prepare

Write up a 3-5 sentence answer to the following interview question:

"How would you approach writing blog content differently now that Google is using AI overviews at the top of search results?"

Aim for your answer to demonstrate your adaptability, understanding of how AI is impacting the SEO industry, and flexible mindset. If you need a refresher, return to the HQ page about AI and SEO, or read this recommended Wordstream article.

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

With Google's AI Overviews providing quick answers directly in search results, I would focus on creating content that goes beyond simple definitions and delivers deeper value through practical advice, expert insights, and detailed explanations. I would also structure blog posts with clear headings, bullet points, and concise summaries so they are easier for search engines to interpret and feature. In addition, I would make sure key brand messages—such as the company's mission, differentiators, and unique value proposition—appear early in the content so they are more likely to be captured in AI-generated summaries. Finally, I would prioritize long-tail keywords and specific user questions to target high-intent searches that AI summaries may not fully answer.

5. LevelUp on LinkedIn (Optional, **10pt Extra Credit**)

Draft a short LinkedIn post about what you've learned while working on CeraVe's SEO strategy. Think about how this project has deepened your understanding of SEO,

keyword research, or audience targeting. You could also mention how you approached optimizing a product page for a real-world brand and customer persona, any tools (like Semrush, Google Trends, or ChatGPT) you used, or any challenges you overcame when working on the project. Referencing what you learned about SEO and AI may also help position you as a savvy, adaptable professional ready for a changing landscape.

Consider adding media, such as a screenshot of your keyword list or your blog content to increase engagement and showcase your work. You may use our LinkedIn Assistant GPT for help crafting a strong post.

Actually posting this on LinkedIn is optional, but highly recommended! As you know, recruiters and potential employers love to see posts that showcase your learning, ambition, and experience.

Please paste the text of your LinkedIn post below. Do not paste screenshots!

(Paste or write your LinkedIn post content below 👇)

SEO Case Study: Why CeraVe Wasn't Showing Up in Google Searches
Why isn't a major skincare brand showing up when someone searches for help with dry skin?
That was the challenge behind a recent SEO strategy project I worked on for CeraVe.
Instead of starting with products, I started with the user.
Meet Carlos — a practical skincare researcher who uses Google to solve problems like dry or flaky skin. He isn't browsing Instagram or TikTok for advice. He searches for answers like:

• “best face wash for men with dry skin”

• “simple skincare routine for men”

• “gentle cleanser for sensitive skin”

To reach users like Carlos, I focused on three key strategies:

🔎 Search intent over search volume

High-volume keywords don’t always mean high impact. Long-tail keywords often reveal clearer user intent and lower competition.

📊 Persona-driven keyword research

Using tools like Semrush and Google Trends, I identified keywords that reflect real user questions and pain points.

🤖 SEO in the age of AI search

With Google AI Overviews answering many queries directly in search results, content now needs to go deeper—providing structured insights, practical guidance, and clear takeaways that AI can reference.

Big takeaway:

SEO today isn’t just about ranking pages. It’s about understanding the person behind the search and creating content that actually solves their problem.

Tools used:

Semrush | Google Trends | ChatGPT

Curious how other marketers are adapting their SEO strategies as AI continues reshaping search?
#SEO #DigitalMarketing #ContentStrategy #AIinMarketing #MarketingStrategy

I did post this!!

CUSTOMER PERSONA

SEO Case Study: Why Isn't CeraVe Showing Up in Google Searches?

Meet Carlos — a practical skincare researcher.
He doesn't browse TikTok or Instagram for skincare advice.
Instead, he searches Google for answers to solve dry skin problems.
Example searches:

- best face wash for men with dry skin
- simple skincare routine for men
- gentle cleanser for sensitive skin

Challenge: How do we make sure CeraVe appears when someone like Carlos searches for solutions?

Marketing Strategy Project | SEO | Audience Research

SEARCH INTENT

SEO Strategy: Understanding Search Intent

Instead of focusing only on high-volume keywords, I prioritized search intent.
Using keyword research tools, I identified long-tail queries with clearer user intent.

Target keywords included:

- simple skincare routine for men with dry skin
- gentle face wash for dry sensitive skin
- ceramides for dry skin benefits

Insight: SEO works best when you understand the problem behind the search.

AI & SEO

What This Project Taught Me About SEO

AI is changing how users interact with search. Google's AI Overviews often answer questions directly on the results page.

Effective content now needs to:

- provide deeper insights than simple answers
- use clear structure for AI summaries
- highlight brand value early in the content

Takeaway: Modern SEO is about solving real problems with helpful, structured content.